

Uddannelsesmuligheder efter folkeskolen



I'm a 16 year old person living in Denmark. I'm born in Denmark, but my parents are from South Africa. I just finished primary school in Denmark and am now considering what my next step should be. I'm fluent in danish. What educational path would you recommend for me?

Thanks for sharing a bit about yourself — that helps a lot in guiding you. Since you're 16 and have just finished **primary school** in Denmark (likely meaning **folkeskolen** up to 9th or 10th grade), you're at an important point where you can choose between several **youth education paths** ("ungdomsuddannelse").

Here are your main options, depending on your interests, goals, and how you like to learn:

1. Gymnasiale uddannelser (General Upper Secondary Education)

If you're interested in **academics** and possibly want to go to **university** later, consider one of the following:

- **STX (Almen studentereksamen)** – Broad academic education, with a mix of science, humanities, and social studies.
- **HHX (Højere handelseksamen)** – Focus on **business, economics, and marketing**.
- **HTX (Højere teknisk eksamen)** – Focus on **technology, science, and innovation**.
- **HF (Højere forberedelseseksamen)** – A shorter, 2-year version, often for more **mature students or practical learners**.

 **Recommended if:** You enjoy subjects like languages, history, biology, tech, or economics, and want to keep doors open to university or higher education.

2. Erhvervsuddannelser (Vocational Education and Training – EUD)

If you want to **learn a trade or practical profession**, and possibly start earning sooner, EUD might be for you. You combine school with paid apprenticeships.

Examples:

- Electrician, carpenter, hairdresser, chef, mechanic, healthcare assistant, etc.

You can also choose the **EUX** path if you want a **vocational education with the option to go to university later**.

 **Recommended if:** You like **hands-on work**, prefer practical learning, and want to join the workforce sooner but still have further study options.

3. 10th Grade (10. klasse)

If you feel unsure about your next step, **10th grade** gives you a chance to grow socially, academically, or personally. You can attend a:

- **Regular school** (folkeskole 10. klasse)
- **Efterskole** – A unique Danish experience! A boarding school where you live with others and focus on academics, sports, music, design, or even international topics.

👉 **Recommended if:** You need time to mature, improve grades, or explore interests in a supportive environment.

Bonus: Your South African Background

Being of South African heritage **can be a strength**, especially if you:

- Speak other languages (e.g., English, Zulu, Afrikaans, Xhosa)
- Are interested in international studies, multicultural work, or global issues

This could make you well-suited for fields like:

- **International business**
 - **Diplomacy or politics**
 - **NGOs or development work**
 - **Cultural studies or language education**
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How to Choose

Ask yourself:

- Do I enjoy theory and reading (→ gymnasiale)?
 - Do I prefer doing things with my hands (→ EUD)?
 - Do I want to study abroad someday?
 - Would I benefit from an extra year (→ 10th or efterskole)?
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If you'd like, I can help you:

- Match your **interests** to specific programs
- Find a local **school or program** near you
- Plan a **pathway** to a certain career (like doctor, engineer, designer, etc.)

Let me know what you're leaning toward or what you're passionate about!